

NATIONAL TECHNICAL RESEARCH ORGANISATION (NTRO)

CYBER THREAT ADVISORY: CRITICAL
INFRASTRUCTURE TARGETING (Q3 2026)

DOCUMENT ID: NTRO-ADV-2026-0894 | CLASSIFICATION: CONFIDENTIAL // TIER-1

ISSUED DATE: 30 August 2026	TARGET SECTORS: Power Grids, Maritime Ports, RTGS Banking
ATTRIBUTION: APT-44 Threat Cluster	RESPONSE WINDOW: Immediate 24-Hour Enforcement

1. EXECUTIVE INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY

During the Q3 2026 monitoring cycle, the Cyber Forensics Division observed coordinated ransomware and persistence operations targeting state-level Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition (SCADA) systems across Indian utility dispatch centers.

Exact Citation Reference [Page 1 / Lines 12-16]:

NTRO intelligence units recorded a 42.8% surge in coordinated ransomware vectors targeting state-level SCADA infrastructure in Q3 2026. Threat actors utilized compromised zero-day vulnerabilities in VPN gateway controllers (CVE-2026-3841) to execute lateral movement across operational technology (OT) network segments.

2. AFFECTED DOMAINS & CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURE MAPPING

Threat reconnaissance telemetry confirmed active intrusion attempts across three critical national economic pillars:

Target Domain	Impacted Facilities	Observed Vector	Threat Level
Power Distribution (Discoms)	14 Load Dispatch Units	Gateway Zero-Day (CVE-2026-3841)	CRITICAL
Maritime Logistics	3 Major Container Terminals	Port Telemetry Jamming & Sniffing	HIGH
Financial Settlement Switches	Inter-Bank RTGS Authentication	Spear Phishing & Token Forgery	HIGH

3. TECHNICAL FORENSICS & LATERAL MOVEMENT

Detailed forensic analysis of disk images retrieved from targeted load dispatch centers revealed unauthorized persistence scripts planted inside core Linux-based routing appliances.

Exact Citation Reference [Page 2 / Lines 22-27]:

14 regional load dispatch centers identified with unauthorized persistence scripts across power distribution networks. Initial entry achieved via unpatched VPN controllers, bypassing standard software authentication firewalls.

4. COMMAND & CONTROL (C2) PROTOCOL ANALYSIS

Exact Citation Reference [Page 2 / Lines 8-11]:

Command and control communication utilized encrypted DNS-over-HTTPS tunnels resolving to dynamic bulletproof hosting clusters located across Eastern Europe, masking outbound exfiltration telemetry.

5. MANDATORY REMEDIATION DIRECTIVES

All chief security officers (CSOs) of regional power grids and port controllers must execute the following remediation matrix within 24 hours of receiving this advisory:

Phase	Action Directive	Responsible Unit	SLA
Phase 1	Deploy CVE-2026-3841 vendor patch on all external VPN gateways	Discom IT / CERT-In	0–24 Hours
Phase 2	Physically air-gap operational SCADA dispatch consoles from public Wi-Fi networks	Grid Operations	24–72 Hours
Phase 3	Mandate physical FIDO2 hardware authentication tokens on dispatch facility CSOs	Facility CSOs	7 Days